

3.7 Your Opinion...

This is probably one of the hardest things to achieve when it comes to blog writing. We're talking about the balance between having an opinion and being neutral.

On the one hand, you need to have an identity, and therefore some opinion about the topics you write about. A piece of writing is bland without an opinion of some sort. On the other hand, do your readers want the facts or do they want your opinion? Then, there's the issue of your readership: if you have an opinion or sentiment you constantly air throughout all your posts, you'll have loyal readers who subscribe to that same opinion. At the same time, you'll lose all your other readers.

Another thing to consider is that constantly airing your opinions could be a put-off for the mere reason that it might sound self-aggrandising. And that's something you definitely don't want if your blog is to be a success with the Internet/Blogging community at large.

There are several answers to the question. First, you will need to identify who will read your blog, and voice (or silence) your opinions accordingly. Second, never ever post an opinion that sounds like a fact! This happens all too often—you'll see a post that says, "The top ten reasons the PS3 will not succeed." Then you'll see a list of reasons, without any sources. Yes, such posts are interesting, but you need to at least throw in a few words to indicate that it is your opinion: "There are several reasons I believe the PS3 will not succeed. I can't say for sure, of course, but here goes..." That, as an introduction to the post, is valuable. And then, you'll need to give sources for all the information you compile into that list.

Third, there's a difference between having an opinion and being opinionated. The latter is, in general, a bad thing: you'll lose some readership on that count alone.